

Manel Leiva

Lead Design Systems Designer

SUMMARY

Lead Design Systems Designer with two production systems built from scratch and a working AI-first workflow. At Remuner I owned the token pipeline and component library end-to-end: Token Studio, Style Dictionary, npm. I used Codex to build the repository infrastructure autonomously: CI validation, drift checks, smoke tests, W3C token migration. The goal was to drive the repo forward without depending on engineering for every change. At Abacum I defined the token architecture and cross-squad governance across a fintech data platform, built the full pipeline with a dedicated engineer, and kept MUI as the base to focus effort on the token layer rather than low-level component work.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer

Remuner

May 2024 - Mar 2026 · Barcelona, hybrid

Built the design system as the sole designer. Token Studio and Figma variables for token authoring, Style Dictionary for multi-target export, npm package for engineering consumption. Storybook for component documentation, Chromatic for visual regression.

Used Codex to build the token repository infrastructure: CI validation pipelines, deterministic drift checks, smoke tests, W3C multi-file token migration, and an HTML sandbox preview for token documentation. The goal was full autonomy over the pipeline without requiring engineering involvement for every change.

Set up a separate icons repository developers could pull without involving design.

Started with a deliberately small token set, applying a lesson from Abacum. A minimal set is easier to govern and scale than a comprehensive one that never gets adopted.

Established the design discipline from scratch: processes, rituals, and documentation the cross-functional team could actually use.

Senior Product Designer

Abacum

Jan 2022 - Apr 2024 · Barcelona, hybrid

Led design system standardisation across squads. Defined the token architecture and component library structure, then built the governance that kept Figma aligned with production through multiple releases.

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Barcelona

Skills

Design Systems: Token Studio, Style Dictionary, Storybook, Chromatic, MUI, npm, ESLint, GitHub, W3C token format

Design: Figma, Figma

variables, component

architecture, token

architecture, documentation,

design critique

AI Workflow: Codex, Claude,

CI pipeline development, token

repository automation

Process: cross-squad

governance, DS adoption

strategies, engineering

handoff, JIRA

Domain: fintech, FP&A, B2B

SaaS, stablecoin-adjacent

payments

Languages

Spanish (native)

Catalan (native)

English (professional)

Built the full engineering pipeline with a dedicated engineer: Token Studio and Style Dictionary for token export, a GitHub submodule connected to an npm package, ESLint rules for adoption enforcement, Storybook in Chromatic for component documentation and visual regression.

Kept MUI as the base component library rather than building from scratch. That decision let us focus effort on the token layer and governance instead of low-level component work.

Presented the DS business case to engineering leadership alongside the head of design. Launched Maker Days to drive adoption across squads.

Senior UX Designer & Co-founder

Kings of Mambo

Sep 2010 - Nov 2021 · Barcelona, hybrid

Co-founded and ran a UX studio for over a decade. Most complex projects: KYMCO Spain's backoffice, vLex Iceberg (a legal document repository), e-commerce builds. Most work meant learning an unfamiliar domain fast and working close enough to engineering to know what I was asking developers to build.

EDUCATION

Higher National Diploma in Computing Design and Multimedia

ESI (Escuela de Sistemas Informáticos)

2002